CYBER CRIME POLICE STATION
ALUVA



INTERNSHIP REPORT

THRISHA V

B.Tech in Computer Science and Engineering (Cybersecurity)

Muthoot Institute of Technology and Science, Varikoli

CYBER CRIME POLICE STATION , ALUVA

CERTIFICATE

This is to certify that **Ms. Thrisha V** successfully completed internship at **Cyber Crime Police Station, Ernakulam Rural**, from **01 June 2026 to 15 June 2026**. During the internship period, she demonstrated professionalism, dedication, and a keen interest in cybercrime investigation procedures and digital forensic practices.

Mr. Jagadeesh V.R.

Station House Officer (SHO)

Aluva Cyber Crime Police Station

Ernakulam Rural, Kerala Police

ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

I would like to express my sincere gratitude to **Mr. Jagadeesh, Station House Officer (SHO)** of the **Cyber Crime Police Station, Aluva**, for providing me with the opportunity to undertake my internship at the station. His guidance, support, and expertise greatly contributed to my understanding of cybercrime investigation and digital forensics.

I am also thankful to the officers and staff of the Cyber Crime Police Station, Aluva, for their cooperation and willingness to share their valuable knowledge and practical experience. Their insights into cybercrime investigations, digital evidence analysis, and law enforcement procedures provided me with a meaningful learning experience and enhanced my practical understanding of cyber forensics.

The exposure to real-world cybercrime cases and investigative techniques has significantly strengthened my academic knowledge and professional skills. I extend my sincere appreciation to the Cyber Crime Police Station, Aluva, for offering me this valuable opportunity and making my internship a rewarding learning experience

PERSONAL INFORMATION

NAME : THRISHA V

COURSE : B.TECH IN COMPUTER SCIENCE AND ENGINEERING (CYBER SECURITY)

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INTERNSHIP PERIOD : 1 JUNE 2026 – 15 JUNE 2026

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TELECOM ANALYSIS AND DIGITAL INVESTIGATION TOOLS

Date: 2nd June 2026

Venue: Superintendent of Police (Rural), Aluva

This training session focused on telecom forensics, mobile device identification, location tracking, and digital investigation tools used during cybercrime investigations. The officers explained how telecommunication records and internet activity logs assist investigators in tracing suspects, identifying devices, and collecting electronic evidence.

The session introduced Call Detail Records (CDR), which contain information regarding incoming and outgoing calls, call duration, timestamps, and associated telecom records. The officers explained the significance of Cell ID and Tower ID in determining the approximate location of a mobile device during a communication event. The concept of antenna sectors was also discussed, including how the direction and coverage area of a cellular antenna assist investigators in narrowing down a device's location.

The officers explained Cell ID address mapping, which helps investigators identify the physical location of a cellular tower. The concept of Tower Dump analysis was introduced, which involves collecting records of all mobile devices connected to a particular tower during a specified time period. Such information is useful in identifying suspects present near a crime scene.

The session further covered International Mobile Equipment Identity (IMEI) and International Mobile Subscriber Identity (IMSI). IMEI was explained as a unique identifier assigned to a mobile device, while IMSI identifies the subscriber associated with a SIM card. The officers discussed how changes in IMEI numbers may indicate a change of device and how IMSI analysis assists in subscriber verification. The method of obtaining IMEI information using the code *#06# was also demonstrated.

The officers explained International Long Distance (ILD) records and their importance in analysing communications involving foreign numbers. The concept of location tracking through cellular towers was introduced, along with methods used to determine the movement of devices based on tower connectivity records.

The session also covered IP Detail Records (IPDR), which provide information regarding internet activity, websites accessed, domain names, IP addresses, and network usage. The role of IPDR analysis in cybercrime investigations was discussed in detail.

Various online investigation tools and resources were introduced, including IMEI information lookup tools, domain investigation tools, and WHOIS lookup services used to identify domain registration information. The officers also explained the analysis of shortened URLs and the use of URL expansion tools to reveal the original destination of suspicious links.

The training provided valuable insight into telecom investigations, mobile device identification, subscriber verification, tower analysis, internet activity monitoring, and the practical use of digital investigation tools in cybercrime investigations.

OSINT TOOLS, ELECTRONIC EVIDENCE, AND LEGAL ADMISSIBILITY OF DIGITAL RECORDS

Date: 3rd June 2026

Venue: Superintendent of Police (Rural), Aluva

This training session focused on Open-Source Intelligence (OSINT) tools, cybercrime investigation procedures, electronic evidence, and the legal framework governing the admissibility of digital records. The officers explained how publicly available information can be used to support investigations and assist in identifying individuals involved in cyber offences.

Various OSINT tools and resources were introduced during the session. The tool WhatsMyName was demonstrated for username-based investigations across multiple social media platforms, enabling investigators to identify online accounts associated with a particular username. The Have I Been Pwned platform was also introduced as a resource for determining whether email addresses or user credentials have been exposed in known data breaches.

The officers discussed cyber investigation platforms such as C-Trace and Khoj, highlighting their role in collecting and analysing information relevant to cybercrime investigations. The practical application of these tools in identifying suspects, tracing digital footprints, and gathering intelligence was explained.

A significant portion of the session focused on electronic evidence and its legal validity. The officers explained the meaning of electronic evidence and electronic records, emphasizing their growing importance in cybercrime investigations and legal proceedings. The essential requirements for the admissibility of electronic evidence were discussed, including relevance, authenticity, integrity of data, proper certification, and proof that the electronic record has not been altered or tampered with.

The session also covered the procedure for issuing certificates relating to electronic records. The officers explained that certificates may be issued by persons having lawful control over a device or system, such as system administrators, information technology managers, bank officials, or other authorised personnel responsible for maintaining electronic records.

The officers further discussed the objectives of cybercrime investigations, including identifying offenders, determining the method of attack, collecting and preserving digital evidence, tracing electronic communications and transactions, preventing further damage, and supporting the prosecution of offenders.

Special emphasis was placed on the provisions of the Bharatiya Sakshya Adhiniyam (BSA), 2023 relating to electronic records. The officers explained the significance of Section 61 concerning electronic and digital records, Section 62 relating to proof of electronic records, and Section 63 regarding the admissibility of electronic evidence before a court of law.

The session provided valuable insight into OSINT techniques, electronic evidence handling, digital investigation procedures, and the legal framework governing electronic records in cybercrime investigations.

AWARENESS SESSION ON DIGITAL WELL-BEING AND MOBILE USAGE

The police officer also conducted an awareness session focusing on the impact of excessive mobile phone usage and digital addiction among students and the general public. The session covered various concerns such as radiation exposure from mobile phones, addiction to smartphones, online games, web series, and the influence of digital content including social media trends and entertainment platforms.

A key topic discussed was the SAR (Specific Absorption Rate) level of mobile phones, which indicates the rate at which the human body absorbs electromagnetic radiation from a device. The officer explained that every mobile phone has a SAR value, and it is important to ensure that the device stays within the safety limits recommended by regulatory authorities. Prolonged exposure to high radiation levels was discussed in terms of potential health risks, and the importance of choosing devices with safe SAR values was emphasized.

The session also explained how users can check the SAR value of their mobile phones through device settings, manufacturer websites, or by dialing specific codes provided by the phone manufacturer. Awareness was created on how to verify whether a mobile device is safe and compliant with standard radiation guidelines.

Real-life cases handled by the police were also shared to illustrate how excessive phone usage and digital addiction can lead to behavioral issues, financial loss, and security risks. A PowerPoint presentation (PPT) was used to effectively present these points along with case examples.

The officer also provided guidance on selecting a mobile phone by considering factors such as security features, privacy controls, device authenticity, and SAR safety levels. The session concluded by emphasizing responsible mobile usage, digital discipline, and maintaining a balanced lifestyle between online and offline activities.

CYBERCRIME INVESTIGATION INSIGHTS

As part of the interactive discussion, the police officer shared insights into several real-world cybercrime cases handled by the Cyber Crime Police Station. These case studies helped in understanding the practical nature of cyber offences and the methods commonly used by cybercriminals.

The officer discussed various incidents involving platforms such as Telegram, Snapchat, and Instagram, where fraudsters exploited fake profiles, impersonation techniques, and deceptive online interactions to carry out scams. Cases related to misuse of social media accounts, manipulation of personal data, and financial fraud were highlighted, showing how victims were misled into transferring money or sharing sensitive information.

The investigation procedures followed in such cases were also briefly explained, including the collection and analysis of digital evidence, identification of suspects through online activity tracing, and coordination with relevant platforms or agencies when required.

These real-life examples provided a clear understanding of the increasing risks in the digital environment and emphasized the importance of cyber awareness and safe online practices. The discussion also highlighted how easily individuals can become victims of online fraud if proper caution is not exercised while using social media and digital communication platforms.

DEMONSTRATION OF FORENSIC TOOLS

The police officer introduced various digital forensic tools and devices commonly used during cybercrime investigations and explained their importance in the acquisition, preservation, and examination of digital evidence. As part of the session, a practical demonstration of Cell Grabber and TD2 (Tableau Forensic Duplicator) was conducted, providing participants with insight into real-world forensic investigation procedures.

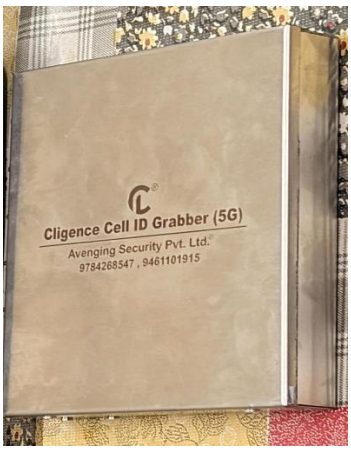
The Cell Grabber tool was demonstrated as a mobile forensic solution used for extracting data from smartphones and other mobile devices. The officer explained how investigators can retrieve information such as call logs, messages, contacts, multimedia files, application data, and device details while maintaining the integrity of the evidence. Its role in investigations involving lost or stolen mobile phones and the recovery of relevant digital evidence was also discussed.

The TD2 (Tableau Forensic Duplicator) was presented as a specialized hardware device used for creating forensic images of digital storage media. The demonstration showed how the device performs bit-by-bit duplication of hard drives, SSDs, USB drives, and other storage devices without altering the original data. The officer also explained how cryptographic hash values are generated and verified during the imaging process to ensure evidence integrity and authenticity.

The session further emphasized the importance of maintaining the chain of custody throughout an investigation to ensure that digital evidence remains reliable and legally admissible in court. The demonstration provided valuable insight into the technologies and procedures used by law enforcement agencies for digital evidence handling and highlighted the crucial role of forensic tools in modern cybercrime investigations.



TD2u



Cell ID Grabber

CYBER CRIME INVESTIGATION CASE STUDY – 1

Case Title: Online Financial Fraud Case

Crime Number: 68/2023
Police Station: Cyber Crime Police Station, Aluva
Court: Chief Judicial Magistrate Court, Ernakulam
Date of Occurrence: 17.02.2023 to 17.03.2023
Date of Report: 02.08.2023
Place of Occurrence: Chambannoor, Angamaly
Property Lost: ₹4,48,000
Accused: Unknown persons
Offences: Section 420 IPC and Section 66(D) of the Information Technology Act

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CASE DETAILS

The complainant stated that unknown individuals deceived the victim through online communication and persuaded him to transfer money under false pretences.

During the period from 17 February 2023 to 17 March 2023, the victim transferred a total amount of ₹4,48,000 through multiple banking transactions.

The investigation revealed that the defrauded amount was transferred through several bank accounts spread across different states. The offenders used mobile phones and digital banking platforms to hide their identity and execute the fraudulent transactions.

The case involved:

- Online financial fraud
- Social engineering techniques and deception
- Use of digital banking systems
- Multiple beneficiary bank accounts
- Mobile-based communication for executing fraud

INVESTIGATION PROCEDURE

- FIR was registered at the Cyber Crime Police Station, Aluva.
- The case was investigated under Section 420 IPC and Section 66(D) of the Information Technology Act.
- Digital evidence such as transaction details, bank account information, mobile numbers, and subscriber data was collected.

- A detailed banking investigation was carried out to track the flow of money through accounts in Kerala Grameen Bank, IDFC Bank, Yes Bank, and Cosmos Co-operative Bank.
- Customer Application Forms (CAF), Call Detail Records (CDR), subscriber details, and location data of the involved mobile numbers were obtained and examined.
- Several account holders from different states, including Maharashtra, Madhya Pradesh, and Telangana, were identified through coordinated banking and telecom inquiries.

DIGITAL EVIDENCE ANALYSIS

The investigation focused on analysing the following digital materials:

- Bank statements and financial records
- Transaction histories
- Mobile numbers used in the fraud
- CAF (Customer Application Forms)
- Call Detail Records (CDR)
- KYC documentation
- Details of beneficiary accounts

The electronic evidence collected was carefully examined to reconstruct the money trail and identify individuals associated with the fraudulent transactions.

CONCLUSION

The investigation involved a detailed scrutiny of banking records, mobile subscriber information, Call Detail Records, and other digital evidence related to the online financial fraud in which the victim suffered a loss of ₹4,48,000.

Although multiple bank accounts and mobile numbers connected to the fraudulent activity were traced, there was insufficient evidence to conclusively identify the actual perpetrators behind the crime. As a result, the case remained undetected at the time of submission of the final report.

This case highlights the complexities involved in cybercrime investigations, especially when offenders use multiple bank accounts, fake identities, and digital communication channels to conceal their operations. It also provides important insights into cybercrime investigation techniques, banking fraud analysis, handling of digital evidence, and the practical application of cyber laws.

CYBER CRIME INVESTIGATION CASE STUDY – 2

Case Title: Social Media Impersonation and Cyber Defamation Case

Crime Number: 03/2021
Police Station: Cyber Crime Police Station, Ernakulam Rural
Court: Chief Judicial Magistrate Court, Ernakulam
Date of Occurrence: Not clearly mentioned (prior to 11.12.2021)
Date of Report: 30.06.2022
Place of Occurrence: Navayikulam, zzThiruvananthapuram District (as per records)
Property Lost: Not applicable
Accused: Identified and arrested
Offences: Section 66(D) of the Information Technology Act and relevant IPC provisions (cheating, impersonation, defamation)

CASE DETAILS

The complainant reported that an unknown person created multiple fake profiles on social media platforms and a dating website (Meetme.com), impersonating known individuals using their photographs.

The accused allegedly used the photographs of the victim's family members, including father, mother, and sister, to create fake profiles under different names such as "Call Me" and others. Through these fake identities, the accused sent inappropriate and defamatory messages via social media platforms and the dating site Meetme.com.

The activity was intended to harass, defame, and insult the victims, thereby damaging their reputation in society.

The case involved:

- Creation of fake social media profiles
- Identity theft and impersonation
- Cyber defamation and harassment
- Use of dating site (Meetme.com) for malicious communication
- Misuse of personal photographs without consent

INVESTIGATION PROCEDURE

- FIR was registered based on the complaint received.

- Investigation was initiated under Section 66(D) of the IT Act and relevant IPC provisions.
- Statements of witnesses and complainant were recorded.
- Digital evidence including fake profiles, messages, and account details were collected.
- Social media and dating site activity (Meetme.com) were analyzed.
- Accused was traced through digital investigation and arrested on 11.12.2021 at 2:00 PM as per records.
- Further verification of residential and identity details of the accused was conducted.

DIGITAL EVIDENCE ANALYSIS

The investigation included examination of:

- Fake social media profiles created using victim's family photographs
- Chat records and messages sent through Meetme.com
- Profile creation data and login traces
- Device and account-related digital footprints
- Witness statements supporting impersonation claims

The analysis confirmed that the accused had systematically used online platforms to impersonate and harass the victims.

CONCLUSION

The investigation confirmed the misuse of social media and dating platforms for impersonation and cyber defamation. The accused created fake profiles using photographs of the victims' family members and sent abusive and defamatory messages.

The accused was identified and arrested during the course of investigation. The case highlights the risks of identity theft, misuse of social media platforms, and cyber harassment.

This case provided important insights into cybercrime investigation procedures, digital evidence collection, social media tracing techniques, and application of cyber laws in impersonation-related offences.

CYBER CRIME INVESTIGATION CASE STUDY – 3

Case Title: Cyber Stalking, Online Harassment and Criminal Intimidation Case

Crime Number: 02/2021 (Cyber Crime Case)
Police Station: Cyber Crime Police Station, Aluva, Ernakulam Rural
Court: District and Sessions Court, Ernakulam
Case Type: Anticipatory Bail / Cyber Crime Investigation Case
Date of Occurrence: 2021
Date of Report: 24.08.2021 (as per court records)
Place of Occurrence: Kerala / Chennai (as per digital communication links)
Accused: Petitioner
Offences: Section 354D IPC, Section 66D of IT Act, Section 120(O) of KP Act (as mentioned in records)

CASE DETAILS

The petitioner was accused in a cyber crime case involving allegations of online harassment, cyber stalking, and misuse of electronic communication platforms.

The complainant alleged that the accused had been in a relationship with the defacto complainant, which later developed into disputes due to disagreements over marriage. It was further alleged that the accused continued communication and interactions through online platforms and mobile communication channels.

The dispute escalated after the complainant's family refused consent for the marriage, following which threats and harassment allegations were raised against the accused. The complainant stated that the accused had been attempting to contact and influence the defacto complainant through electronic communication.

The case involved:

- Cyber stalking and online harassment
- Misuse of electronic communication (email/Instagram)
- Interpersonal dispute leading to cyber complaint
- Allegations of criminal intimidation
- Digital communication evidence (messages, emails, screenshots)

INVESTIGATION PROCEDURE

- FIR was registered at Cyber Crime Police Station, Aluva.

- Investigation was conducted under relevant sections of IPC and IT Act.
- Statements from complainant and witnesses were recorded.
- Digital communication records including emails, Instagram messages, and chat screenshots were collected.
- CAF (Customer Application Form) details and subscriber data of mobile numbers were examined.
- Case records were submitted before the District and Sessions Court, Ernakulam in connection with anticipatory bail petition (Cr.M.C No. 1773/2021 and related proceedings).
- Analysis of electronic evidence and communication history was carried out to verify allegations.

DIGITAL EVIDENCE ANALYSIS

The investigation involved examination of:

- Email communications between parties
- Instagram chat records and profile activity
- Screenshot evidence submitted by complainant
- CAF and mobile subscriber details
- FIR and court-related digital submissions
- Call and message communication patterns

The evidence primarily focused on verifying whether the communication constituted harassment, stalking, or criminal intimidation under cyber laws.

CONCLUSION

The investigation revealed that the case originated from a personal dispute that escalated into allegations of cyber harassment and stalking through electronic communication platforms. The accused was booked under relevant provisions of IPC and IT Act based on the complaint. However, the matter also involved interpersonal relationship issues, which complicated the interpretation of intent behind the digital communication.

The case highlights the importance of distinguishing between personal disputes and cybercrime offences, and demonstrates the role of digital evidence such as emails, chat records, and social media activity in cybercrime investigations. It also provides insight into anticipatory bail proceedings, electronic evidence evaluation, and application of cyber laws in cases involving social media communication.

CYBER CRIME INVESTIGATION CASE STUDY – 4

Case Title: Online Financial Fraud and Bank Account Misuse Case

Crime Number: 18/2022

Police Station: Cyber Police Station, Ernakulam

Court: Jurisdictional Judicial Magistrate Court, Ernakulam

Case Type: Cyber Financial Fraud / Cheating through Electronic Means

Date of Occurrence: 29.07.2022

Date of Final Report: 30.04.2024

Place of Occurrence: Ernakulam and other locations connected through banking and digital transactions

Accused: Multiple accused persons

Offences:
• Section 420 IPC
• Section 66(D) of Information Technology Act

CASE DETAILS

The case originated from a complaint alleging online financial fraud and cheating through electronic communication. The complainant was induced to transfer money through electronic means to bank accounts operated by the accused persons.

Investigation revealed that the funds were subsequently transferred and withdrawn through various banking channels. The accused persons allegedly utilized bank accounts and digital communication platforms for carrying out fraudulent activities.

The case involved:

• Online financial fraud

• Electronic cheating

• Fraudulent banking transactions

• ATM cash withdrawals

• WhatsApp communications

• Digital transaction receipts

• KYC verification

• Identity document verification

INVESTIGATION PROCEDURE

1. FIR was registered at Cyber Police Station, Ernakulam.
2. Statements of complainant and witnesses were recorded.
3. Federal Bank and IDFC First Bank account details were collected.
4. Certified account statements were obtained.
5. Account opening forms were examined.
6. PAN Card, Passport and KYC documents were verified.
7. ATM withdrawal details were collected.
8. CCTV footage relating to ATM transactions was obtained.
9. Customer Application Forms (CAF) and subscriber details were examined.
10. WhatsApp chats, receipts and electronic records were analyzed.
11. Transaction trails were traced through banking records.

DIGITAL EVIDENCE ANALYSIS

The following electronic evidence was examined:

• WhatsApp chat records

• Transaction receipts

• Bank account statements

• ATM withdrawal records

• CCTV footage

• Account opening forms

• PAN card records

• Passport details

• KYC documents

• CAF records

• Mobile subscriber information

• Certified electronic records under the Bankers' Books Evidence Act

The collected evidence was analyzed to establish ownership of bank accounts, movement of funds and involvement of accused persons.

BANKING AND FORENSIC ANALYSIS

Investigation revealed that the disputed funds were credited to accounts maintained in Federal Bank and IDFC First Bank.

Detailed scrutiny of account statements established:

• Receipt of funds

• Subsequent transfers

• ATM withdrawals

• Account operation patterns

The ATM withdrawal timings were correlated with CCTV footage and banking records. KYC documentation was verified to identify the account holders and establish links with the accused persons.

FINDINGS

The investigation established that:

• The complainant transferred money based on electronic communications.

• The funds were credited to identified bank accounts.

• The accused persons were connected to the accounts through KYC records.

• ATM withdrawals matched the disputed transactions.

• WhatsApp communications supported the complainant's allegations.

• Documentary and electronic evidence established a prima facie case against the accused.

CONCLUSION

The investigation concluded that sufficient documentary, banking and electronic evidence existed to establish a prima facie case of cheating and online financial fraud.

The evidence included:

• Bank statements

• Account opening forms

• KYC documents

• ATM withdrawal records

• CCTV footage

• WhatsApp communications

• Transaction receipts

Accordingly, the Final Report/Charge Sheet was submitted recommending prosecution of the accused persons under Section 420 IPC and Section 66(D) of the Information Technology Act.

CYBER CRIME INVESTIGATION CASE STUDY – 5

Case Title: Online Job Fraud through WhatsApp Recruitment Scam

Crime Number: Crime No. 71/2023

Police Station: Cyber Crime Police Station, Ernakulam Rural

Court: Chief Judicial Magistrate Court, Ernakulam

Date of Occurrence: July 2023 – August 2023

Date of Report: 31.01.2024

Place of Occurrence: Online (WhatsApp Platform)

Complainant: Name Withheld

Accused: Name Withheld

Property Lost: ₹24,575/-

Offences:

• Section 420 of the Indian Penal Code (IPC)

• Section 66(D) of the Information Technology Act, 2000

CASE DETAILS

The complainant received a WhatsApp message from an unknown individual claiming to represent a recruitment agency or human resources department. The accused informed the complainant about a purported job opportunity and convinced the victim that certain payments were necessary for registration, verification, and processing of employment-related formalities.

Believing the offer to be genuine, the complainant transferred money on multiple occasions to the bank account specified by the fraudster. After receiving the payments, the accused neither provided any employment opportunity nor responded to further communications.

Upon realizing that the job offer was fraudulent, the complainant approached the Cyber Crime Police Station and filed a complaint regarding the financial loss incurred.

The case involved:

• Online job recruitment fraud

• WhatsApp-based impersonation

• Cyber-enabled financial cheating

• Fraudulent collection of money under the guise of employment

• Use of digital communication platforms for deception

INVESTIGATION PROCEDURE

• A case was registered based on the complaint under the relevant provisions of the IPC and Information Technology Act.

• The investigating officer collected digital evidence, including WhatsApp chat records, screenshots of conversations, transaction receipts, bank account details, and mobile number information.

• Notices were issued to the concerned banks requesting beneficiary account details, account statements, KYC records, account opening forms, and customer identification documents.

• Requests were forwarded to telecom service providers seeking Customer Application Forms (CAF), subscriber details, address verification records, and ownership information relating to the mobile numbers used in the fraud.

• A financial investigation was conducted to examine fund transfers, transaction history, beneficiary account activities, and withdrawal patterns.

• Field verification was carried out using the addresses obtained from CAF records and KYC documents. Local enquiries were conducted to ascertain the identity and location of the accused.

• ATM transaction records and CCTV footage corresponding to withdrawals from the beneficiary account were collected and examined.

DIGITAL EVIDENCE ANALYSIS

The investigation involved examination of the following digital evidence:

Communication Records

• WhatsApp chat messages

• Screenshots of conversations

• Job-related communication records

Banking Records

• Bank account statements

• Account opening forms

• KYC documents

• Transaction histories

• Beneficiary account details

Telecom Records

• Customer Application Forms (CAF)

• Subscriber information

• Mobile ownership details

Surveillance Evidence

• ATM withdrawal records

• CCTV footage from ATM locations

Identity Documents

• Address proof documents

• Customer identification records

• Bank verification records

The collected electronic evidence was analysed to establish the identity of the accused, verify ownership of the bank account and mobile number used in the fraud, and trace the movement of funds received from the complainant.

FINDINGS

The investigation revealed that:

• The complainant was induced to transfer money based on false promises of employment opportunities.

• The WhatsApp account used for communication was traced through subscriber and telecom records.

• The beneficiary bank account receiving the fraudulently obtained money was successfully identified.

• KYC documents and account opening records established the identity of the account holder.

• Transaction analysis confirmed receipt of the cheated amount in the beneficiary account.

• ATM withdrawal records and CCTV footage provided supporting evidence regarding operation of the account.

• Combined analysis of banking and telecom records enabled investigators to identify the accused involved in the fraud.

CONCLUSION

The investigation established that the accused deceived the complainant by offering a fake employment opportunity through WhatsApp communication and induced the victim to transfer money under the pretext of job processing and registration fees.

Analysis of digital evidence, banking records, telecom subscriber details, KYC documents, ATM transaction records, and CCTV footage collectively established the involvement of the accused in the offence.

The investigation successfully identified the beneficiary account holder and connected the fraudulent transactions to the accused through documentary and electronic evidence.

CYBER CRIME INVESTIGATION CASE STUDY – 6

Case Title: Forex Trading Investment Fraud through a Fake Online Trading Platform

Crime Number: 41/2024

Police Station: Cyber Crime Police Station, Ernakulam Rural

Court: Chief Judicial Magistrate Court, Ernakulam

Date of Occurrence: 26.10.2024 to 03.12.2024

Date of Report: 05.12.2024

Place of Occurrence: Online

Complainant: Jomy Poonoly

Accused: Initially Unknown (Subsequently Identified)

Property Lost: ₹41,21,514/-

Offences / Sections Applied:

• Section 318(4) of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita (BNS), 2023

• Section 66(D) of the Information Technology Act, 2000

CASE DETAILS

The complainant was approached through online communication channels and was encouraged to invest in Forex Trading using a platform known as ANZO Capital. The fraudsters portrayed the platform as a profitable investment opportunity and assured the complainant of substantial returns through foreign exchange trading activities.

Trusting the promises made by the perpetrators, the complainant transferred money through multiple transactions to various bank accounts provided by them. To gain the victim's confidence, the online trading dashboard displayed fictitious profits and increasing account balances.

However, when the complainant attempted to withdraw the invested amount and accumulated profits, the fraudsters demanded additional payments under different pretexts. Eventually, all communication ceased, and the suspects became untraceable.

Realizing that he had been deceived, the complainant filed a complaint before the Cyber Crime Police Station, Ernakulam Rural.

Nature of Crime:

• Online Investment Fraud

• Forex Trading Scam

• Cyber-Enabled Financial Fraud

• Cheating through a Fake Trading Platform

• Use of Money Mule Accounts

INVESTIGATION PROCEDURE

1. FIR Registration

Based on the complaint received, FIR No. 41/2024 was registered under the relevant provisions of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita and the Information Technology Act.

2. Collection of Digital Evidence

The investigating officer gathered various forms of electronic evidence, including:

• Screenshots of the trading platform

• Bank transaction receipts

• Fund transfer details

• Mobile numbers used by the suspects

• Email communications

• Complaint documents submitted by the victim

3. Banking Investigation

Official notices were issued to several banks seeking:

• Account opening forms

• KYC records

• Bank account statements

• Beneficiary account details

• Transaction histories

• Information regarding linked accounts

4. Financial Trail Analysis

A comprehensive analysis of the money trail was conducted to trace the movement of funds across multiple financial institutions, including:

• Axis Bank

• Federal Bank

• Bandhan Bank

• Canara Bank

• Kotak Mahindra Bank

• Jana Small Finance Bank

The objective was to identify the ultimate recipients and beneficiaries of the fraudulently obtained funds.

5. KYC and Beneficiary Verification

Detailed verification of beneficiary accounts was undertaken using:

• KYC documentation

• Identity proofs

• Address verification records

• Mobile number verification details

• Customer onboarding records

6. Arrest and Custodial Investigation

During the course of the investigation, one of the beneficiary account holders was identified as being directly connected to the fraudulent transactions.

The accused was arrested on 06.01.2025 and subjected to custodial interrogation. Electronic devices, including a mobile phone recovered from the accused, were seized and examined for evidentiary purposes.

DIGITAL EVIDENCE ANALYSIS

The investigation involved a detailed examination of the following digital and financial records:

Banking Records

• Bank account statements

• Fund transfer records

• Transaction reference numbers

• Beneficiary account information

• Account opening documents

Identity and Verification Documents

• KYC records

• Aadhaar-based verification records

• Customer identification documents

Communication Records

• Mobile numbers linked to the transactions

• Email correspondence

• Trading platform records and activity logs

Device Evidence

• Mobile phone seized from the accused

• Subscriber information

• Digital account access details

Financial Intelligence Records

• Layered transaction analysis

• Inter-bank fund transfer records

• Beneficiary tracing reports

The collected evidence was carefully analysed to establish the movement of funds, identify beneficiaries, and determine the involvement of the accused in the fraudulent scheme.

FINDINGS

The investigation established that:

• The complainant invested money after being misled by promises of high profits from Forex trading.

• A total amount of approximately ₹41,21,514/- was transferred through multiple banking transactions.

• The fraud proceeds were routed through several bank accounts to conceal the identities of the beneficiaries.

• Detailed banking analysis successfully reconstructed the transaction trail.

• KYC records enabled investigators to identify the holder of one of the beneficiary accounts.

• Banking records confirmed both the receipt and withdrawal of the defrauded funds.

• Financial and documentary evidence connected the accused to the fraudulent banking network.

• The accused was arrested and subjected to further investigation and interrogation.

CONCLUSION

The investigation conclusively established that the complainant was defrauded through a fake Forex Trading investment scheme operated via an online trading platform.

The accused, along with other associated beneficiaries, induced the victim to transfer substantial amounts of money by making false promises of exceptionally high investment returns.

Through extensive examination of banking records, KYC documents, transaction trails, digital communications, electronic devices, and custodial interrogation, investigators were able to identify and arrest one of the individuals involved in the fraud.

This case highlights the growing threat of online investment scams, the misuse of digital financial systems, and the importance of banking analysis, digital evidence examination, and inter-agency cooperation in cybercrime investigations.

.

CYBER CRIME INVESTIGATION CASE STUDY – 7

Case Title: Fake Facebook Profile Creation, Cyber Harassment and Online Defamation Case

Crime Number: 11/2024

Police Station: Cyber Crime Police Station, Ernakulam Rural

District: Ernakulam Rural

Date of Occurrence: 12.02.2024 to 31.03.2024

Date of Registration: 06.04.2024

Place of Occurrence: Koovappady Village, Ernakulam

Complainant: Subi (41) (Name partially withheld)

Accused: Initially Unknown; Later Identified as Riju Davis

Property Lost: Nil

Offences / Sections Applied:

- Section 66D, Information Technology Act, 2000
- Section 120(o), Kerala Police Act, 2011

CASE DETAILS

The complainant alleged that she was subjected to continuous online harassment through WhatsApp messages and fake social media profiles. Beginning in February 2024, she received messages from an unknown WhatsApp number containing defamatory and offensive content intended to harass and intimidate her.

Subsequently, multiple fake Facebook accounts were created using the complainant's photographs without her knowledge or consent. The fake profiles appeared under names such as **“Subi Das,” “Subi Shaji,”** and other similar identities. These profiles contained photographs and posts that falsely represented the complainant and portrayed her in a defamatory manner.

The complainant stated that the profiles were created solely to damage her reputation and create social embarrassment. As the fake accounts continued to appear even after earlier accounts disappeared, she approached the Cyber Crime Police Station and lodged a formal complaint.

Nature of Crime

- Cyber Harassment

- Online Defamation
- Identity Theft
- Fake Social Media Profile Creation
- Impersonation using Social Media Platforms
- Misuse of WhatsApp and Facebook for Harassment

INVESTIGATION PROCEDURE

1. Registration of FIR

Based on the complaint received from the victim, FIR No. 11/2024 was registered under the relevant provisions of the Kerala Police Act and Information Technology Act.

2. Collection of Digital Evidence

The investigating officer collected:

- WhatsApp messages received by the complainant
- Screenshots of fake Facebook profiles
- URLs of the fake Facebook accounts
- Profile photographs used in the fake accounts
- Digital records submitted by the complainant

3. Social Media Investigation

Requests were sent to Facebook/Meta seeking:

- Account registration details
- IP address logs
- Login history
- Subscriber information
- Account creation records

4. Telecom Investigation

The investigating team obtained:

- CAF (Customer Application Form) records
- CDR (Call Detail Records)
- Subscriber information

- SIM ownership details
- Address verification records

5. Witness Examination

Several witnesses familiar with the complainant and the accused were examined. Statements were recorded regarding:

- The relationship between the parties
- Previous disputes and personal conflicts
- Possible motives behind the creation of fake accounts

6. Identification of Suspect

Analysis of telecom records, social media information, and witness statements led investigators to suspect and later identify the accused.

7. Verification of Digital Activities

The investigating officer correlated:

- WhatsApp communication records
- Facebook account activity
- Device usage patterns
- Subscriber information
- IP-related information

DIGITAL EVIDENCE ANALYSIS

The following digital evidence was examined:

Communication Records

- WhatsApp messages sent to the complainant
- Message screenshots
- Contact details linked to the communication

Social Media Evidence

- Fake Facebook profiles
- Facebook URLs
- Profile photographs
- Login and account activity records

Telecom Records

- CAF records
- Subscriber information
- Mobile ownership records
- Call Detail Records (CDR)

Device Information

- Mobile devices linked to the accounts
- SIM card details
- Account access records

Witness Statements

- Statements of persons acquainted with both parties
- Information regarding motive and prior disputes

FINDINGS

The investigation revealed that:

- Multiple fake Facebook profiles were created using the complainant's photographs without permission.
- The fake profiles were used to impersonate and harass the complainant.
- The complainant received messages from WhatsApp numbers connected to the incident.
- Telecom investigation helped trace the mobile numbers involved.
- Witness statements established the existence of previous personal disputes between the parties.
- Digital evidence linked the creation and operation of the fake accounts to the accused.
- Investigation indicated that the fake profiles were created with the intention of causing harassment, humiliation, and reputational damage to the complainant.
- The accused was successfully identified through a combination of digital evidence, subscriber records, and witness testimony.

CONCLUSION

The investigation established that the complainant was subjected to cyber harassment through fake Facebook profiles and WhatsApp communications. The accused allegedly created and operated multiple social media accounts using the complainant's photographs and identity without authorization, thereby impersonating and defaming her online.

Through analysis of social media records, CAF details, CDR reports, digital evidence, and witness statements, investigators were able to identify the accused and establish a connection between the fraudulent online activities and the suspect. The case demonstrates the importance of digital evidence analysis in investigating cyber harassment, online impersonation, and social media-based offences.